Coding Guide for DANISH Twitter Counter Speech Dataset

Description of Dataset

The data stems from Danish Twitter users and spans the period from 2009 to 2022.

The dataset consists of **pairs of tweets**. The first tweet (called the *referenced tweet*) can be a tweet of any kind, i.e., an original post, a reply to a tweet, or a quote tweet. The second tweet will always be a reply or quote tweet of the referenced tweet (i.e., the *reply tweet*). **ONLY the reply tweet will be coded.** All tweets will be coded based on textual information only (pictures, videos, or linked content has been removed).

Referenced tweets have been pre-selected from a wider dataset of tweets based on their scoring by A&ttack and Rec&nition algorithms, such that 250 where labelled attacking, 250 were labelled recognizing, 106 were labelled both (we did not have 250 examples labelled both), and the rest were drawn randomly from a larger set of tweets.

The total number of tweet-pairs to be coded is 1000.

Note that tweets have been cleaned in the following way:

- Tagged usernames have been anonymized, except for users that are named at least 50 times in the dataset, for which we can assume that they constitute some kind of public figure or celebrity. Anonymized usernames were replaced with "@user".
- All links have been replaced with "<link>".

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Coding strategy and coding categories

ONLY the reply tweet will be coded. The reference tweet is there to provide the sometimes necessary context to understand the meaning of a reply tweet.

All tweet-pairs will be coded by all three annotators, to assess intercoder reliability.

The tweets will be coded along the following dimensions / labels:

- Tweet Tone
  - Hateful
  - Constructive

- Agreement with reference tweet (only for reply tweets)
  - Agree
  - Disagree
  - Unclear

- Unclassifiable

Please note that **sometimes, tweets may contain elements of several dimensions**. In these cases, **tweets should be labelled using all the categories that apply**. For example, if a tweet contains some constructive notions, but is also very hateful, this tweet should be coded as both constructive and hateful.

In the following, we describe the different coding labels to be used for the reply tweets. Each label description comes with a few examples and explanations for why these tweets should be coded in the described way.

Tweet Tone

This set of labels regards the tone of the tweet, whether it has elements that are hateful or constructive. Importantly, **it is possible for tweets to have both hateful and constructive elements or neither of them to a sufficient extent (neutral tweets).**

Hateful

Does the tweet contain hateful elements?

Hateful elements are defined as *any expression of the motivation to degrade, harass, or intimidate individuals or collectives based on political differences or discriminatory views.*

This is always a judgement call, as the intention of the tweet author can be very hard to infer, but a couple of *rules of thumb* could help:

1. Statements that ascribe demeaning or dehumanizing characteristics to an individual or group by labeling them as e.g., stupid, evil, a troll, nazi, despicable, dogs etc. are often hateful.

2. Statements that say "I hate X" should be coded as hateful, when X refers to a person or group of people. One caveat applies in that sometimes, people use the word hate in a very soft way ("I hate to bother you, but…"). In these cases, or when statements are ironic, tweets should not be regarded as hateful.

3. Statements that are uncivil, make use of slurs (e.g. the N word), are often hateful. Not all uncivil comments are necessarily hateful, but the use of derogatory terms can be a good indicator of hateful messages.

4. Statements that are *merely* saying that someone is hateful (e.g., "Trump is so full of hate"), do **not** count as hateful. While these tweets may typically be antagonizing, the mere accusation of someone or some group being hateful is not enough. Of course, when such statements are accompanied by other hateful markers, they should still be labelled as hateful.

Examples of hateful reply tweets:

i. ***Referenced tweet:***
Since I called #Individual1 a piece of shit for congratulating a judge for trying to takeaway the ACA, again, in the last hour I've been called a leftist, ignoramous, Libby, libtard, stupid, loser, & a host of other great adjectives by BOTS & MAGATS. What a great night

Reply tweet:
@user #TrumpCultists hate the truth. They're also riled up because they are finally faced with the knowledge their hero is a traitor and a crook.

→ This reply doubles down on hate leveled towards "TrumpCultists". It further propagates hateful messages regarding Trump calling him names derogatory terms like 'traitor' and 'crook'.

ii. ***Referenced tweet:***
@user Let's only hope that the protection of freedom of speech will not become a too easy excuse for parents, teachers, community and educators to do nothing about this painful public expression of hate speech in the form of the Nazi salute.

Reply tweet:
@user @user Could you people be any dumber? The photographer asked them to put their hands in the air to wave it's not a fucking Nazi salute. They're a bunch of school kids not Rudolph Hess. Stop looking for Nazis under every rock.

→ This reply attacks the author of the referenced tweet ("any dumber") with a derogatory term.

iii. ***Referenced tweet:***
First off @user what the heck are still doing there continuing with you lies & hate rhetoric! I thought you were leaving 💁

Secondly as you speak for a man who spews hate worst than any other leader in this country. Disgraceful & SAD!

#ResignTrump

Reply tweet:
@user @user What is outrageous & inappropriate is you, ugly Sarah.

→ This reply attacks the author of the referenced tweet by calling her 'ugly'.

Examples of antagonistic but **NOT** hateful tweets:

i. *The president's fans seem far more upset by my (obvious) joke about banning hats than they were when the President said literally the same thing about banning actual human beings. Go figure.*

→ This tweet is antagonizing against Trump "fans". It is accusing them of hypocrisy, but it is not degrading or demeaning as such.

ii. *Bad faith "readings" and emotionalism all over the place. If people can't reason about a serious lacuna in the progressive platform, then the Republic is screwed.*

→ This tweet is accusing progressives of being overly emotional and acting in bad faith.

iii. *Is it just me, or are other people sick of Republican senators looking very, very concerned – without actually doing anything?*

→ This tweet is accusing Republican senators of being hypocritical by looking concerned but not doing anything. While this reads as a strong critique, it does not qualify as degrading.

Constructive

Does the tweet contain constructive or prosocial elements?

Constructive elements imply a prosocial attitude, signaling the *disapproval of hate or hostile behavior, or tweets that aim to side with, shield or comfort an individual victim or victimized group.* In other words, the tweet tries to establish or restore favorable conditions for civil political discussion online (either in the short or the long term).

Note that the **mere labelling of** someone as a racist, white supremacist, liar, …, without backing up these statements with information about why this accusation is deserved should **not** count as constructive. For example: "Politician X is a racist" is not constructive, whereas "This law is racist because it will affect black people differently from white people" would count as constructive.

Depending on whom they address (victim of hate, perpetrator of hate, larger audience), constructive tweets may take the following forms:

Towards victims of hate:

- Expressing support *("I am with you", "I am here", "DMs are always open if you want to talk", "I am so sorry you have to experience this")*
- Shielding *("Don't listen to this jerk")*
- Offering advice *("this is over the line. Don't feel bad about reporting people that act like this")*

Towards perpetrators of hate:

- trying to educate authors of a hateful post by providing facts that counter the hateful message (e.g. "this is actually not correct, the xxx clearly states that …"), in a sincere and non-ironic manner.
- Pointing out inconsistencies by asking questions, in a Socratic manner, "If you think this is true, do you also think that ... is true?"
- warning them of consequences of hateful messages (e.g., "your comment is against platform regulations! Be careful, or your account might get deleted", "blocked and reported")
- trying to get perpetrators to empathize with the target of their hate (e.g., "this is hurtful to xxx")
- calling out hate speech, but note mere labelling exception detailed above (e.g. "this is racism", "this is hatespeech", …)
- appealing to a shared trait, e.g. common humanity, equal rights ("we're all human", …)

Towards the general public / Twitter audience:

- Calling for a better culture of debate (e.g., "Let's keep things civil and informative on here")

Examples of constructive reply tweets:

iv. ***Referenced tweet:***
Scares me that people like this actually can vote to be honest. There's a difference between political opinion and flat out ignorance and disrespect. <link>

Reply tweet:
Nah fuck this. Everyone deserves the right to vote. Every voice should be heard even if it's a shitty voice. <link>

→ This reply is appealing to equal rights to vote despite differing opinions. It is a call to tolerating voices you disagree with, accepting their equal right.

v. **Referenced tweet:**
Some very odd people R saying I'm a pedo, re: a joke from a time not that long ago when hard absurd jokes by comedians were acknowledged for what they were — jokes — not a disingenuous national threat to people fake-clutching their pearls (whilst ranting the country's too PC)

Reply tweet:
@user @user #Pedophile "jokes" are not jokes at all. There's nothing even remotely funny about them. If you make those jokes then you are complicit. #PedoWood #Pedogate #Pizzagate #TheGreatAwakening #WalkAway

→ This tweet is trying to educate the author of the referenced tweet that pedophile jokes are no "joking matter". Note that although the author of the reply tweet is a likely Qanon supporter (as identifiable by the hashtags they use), the notion of this tweet can however still be considered constructive.

vi. **Referenced tweet:**
@user @user I'm a total man, but stand up for American women and I stand against oppression and ANY KIND of prejudice: be it color of skin/Belief, or lack of, God, Nationality, gender, preference of sex...FOLKS, THIS SUPPOSED TO BE THE LAND OF THE FREE...LET'S MAKE IT TRULY FREE!!

Reply tweet:
@user @user @user You got it right Charles, you are a total man. ♡

→ This tweet is supporting the author of the referenced tweet in their positive message of standing up against all kinds of prejudice.

vii. ***Referenced tweet:***
@user @user'Liberals don't believe in free speech. They want to silence anyone that doesn't agree with them or criticizes them.

Reply tweet:
@user If I told everyone your children who were killed in a mass shooting are crisis actors, I would be furious too. Be best. 😘

→ This reply is constructive because it tries to elicit empathy with the target in the hater.

viii. ***Referenced tweet:***
@user @user I'd just like a day off from the hassles. Making claims of hate speech or sexist speech when none exists is abuse, especially when used to call in others based on that allegation. That's targeted harassment.

Reply tweet:
Rude boy continues not to apologize for sexist #hatespeech . Women scientists may be wrong, but they are not "kooky." <link>

→ Both referenced tweet and reply are constructive. They are both calling each other out, and doing so in an informative way, i.e., explaining what the offending behavior is and why it's hurtful. Note that the reply is also hateful, calling the author of the referenced tweet a rude "boy" is demeaning – implying that they have limited intellectual capacities.

Examples of both hateful AND constructive tweets

As stated above, sometimes tweets can have both hateful *and* constructive elements. Here are a few examples:

ix. *Jesus, Trump's Montana speech reads like straight-up evil. Lie upon lie upon lie, broken up by hate speech and deeply personal insults aimed at pretty much anyone who opposes him. Anything unflattering is fake, everyone else is bad and stupid… WTF*

→ this tweet is both calling out something hateful in a detailed way (constructive), but is also hateful in the way it does it, implying that Trump is 'straight-up evil' and a liar.

x. *Since 2012, Ogawa Eitaro, has been the lapdog and the pit-bull of Prime Minister Abe. He published and essay that argued men should have the right to molest women and that LGBT were no different from ass-fetishists and deserved no rights.*

→ this tweet is both calling out something hateful (Eitaro is hateful against women and LGBT people), but is also hateful in calling him 'lapdog' and 'pit-bull' which is dehumanizing.

Agreement with referenced tweet

Agreement with the referenced tweet is supposed to indicate whether the reply tweet author agrees in spirit with what is said in the referenced tweet. Note that sometimes, people may agree **ironically**, thus such tweets should ideally be coded as disagreeing.

For example, this helps disambiguate whether a hateful reply to a hateful reference tweet is doubling down on the hate (agreeing), or countering hate with hate (disagreeing).

This set of labels is **mutually exclusive** (replies cannot agree and disagree at the same time). If the stance of the reply is unclear, or mixed, reply tweet agreement should be coded as "unclear".

Note: A special rule of thumb that applies when replies are agreeing is the ***inheritance rule***. Reply tweets that agree with the referenced tweet typically inherit the tweet *type* categorization of the referenced tweet (i.e., they should be coded in similar ways), unless they clearly deviate in type. This most often applies when replies are ***short***. For instance, if someone replies to a hateful tweet with "so true", this reply should also be labelled as hateful.

Agree Examples

i. ***Referenced tweet:***
Since I called #Individual1 a piece of shit for congratulating a judge for trying to takeaway the ACA, again, in the last hour I've been called a leftist, ignoramous, Libby, libtard, stupid, loser, & a host of other great adjectives by BOTS & MAGATS. What a great night

Reply tweet:
@user #TrumpCultists hate the truth. They're also riled up because they are finally faced with the knowledge their hero is a traitor and a crook.

→ This reply is agreeing with the referenced tweet by further attacking the victim (i.e., it is doubling down on hate).

ii. **Referenced tweet:**
fuck paul ryan, fuck everyone who enabled him and thank god the next generation of journalists knows that a white supremacist enabler with a powerful chin is still a white supremacist enabler

Reply tweet:
@user I love you. I'm writing 500 words as we speak about why Paul Ryan is one of the worst people in the world. Thank you for this.

→ This reply is agreeing with / doubling down on the hate against Paul Ryan in the referenced tweet.

iii. **Referenced tweet:**
She's got game! I am going to enjoy the spunky kid in her, while hating her dangerous, harebrained socialist claptrap. <link>

Reply tweet:
She is so adorable. Bad teeth, no shame about calling attn to same w red lipstick,

& all. Little-kid look goes with the naivete about politics. I'm glad at least my USRep remembers socialism has already failed. <link>

→ The reply is agreeing with the hateful portrayal first expressed in the referenced tweet by painting a picture of the person as naïve and kid-like in her view on politics. It thus doubles down on the hate.

iv. **Referenced tweet:**
I understand that you may be afraid to tweet #StopTheBias because you're afraid that you may be banned next. And that may happen. But if we don't stand for free speech, what do we stand for?

Reply tweet:
*If we all tweet #StopTheBias and support @user & @user , we *might* restore reason to @Twitter. If Twitter bans more people, Twitter loses credibility...I was last banned by Associated Content,. Hoot. Remember Associated Content? <link>*

→ The reply author is agreeing with the political protest idea in tweeting "stop the bias" tweets.

Disagree Examples

i. ***Referenced tweet:***
@user @user Liberals don't believe in free speech. They want to silence anyone that doesn't agree with them or criticizes them.

Reply tweet:
@user If I told everyone your children who were killed in a mass shooting are crisis actors, I would be furious too. Be best. 😘

→ This reply is disagreeing (constructively) with the referenced tweet.

ii. **Referenced tweet:**
This is the party of "tolerance". The leftists have really lost touch.
They have no platform other than hate and they can't stand that @user is winning and showing Americans how bad their liberal policies have been for America.
Even the media can't fix it for them!

Reply tweet:
@user @user Right. Dems are the hateful ones? Look in the mirror.

→ This reply is disagreeing with the tweet author by countering a hateful counterspeech message with hate directed towards the author of the referenced tweet.

iii. **Referenced tweet:**
How awful. Criticizing poor scholarship is not sexist or hate speech. Another example of misuse to #MeToo to foment anger against #scicomm and public scientists speaking the truth. <link>

Reply tweet:
Scientists can criticize poor scholarship by raising issues with articles, but not with #hatespeech like calling women "kooky." #MeToo <link>

→ This reply is disagreeing with the statement in the referenced tweet and provides a clear a constructive example of how one could alternatively (e.g., by raising issues with articles) have phrased one's critique in a more pro-social way.

Unclear

(see also unclassifiable examples below)

i. ***Referenced tweet:***
If you do not want that kind of support, you do actually have to overtly denounce them.

Reply tweet:
Wtf is happening to this country!?

→ It is unclear what exactly the intention of the reply is. Without knowing more of the context, the question could be read both as in agreement (why are people not denouncing this), or as in disagreement (a general sense of despair)

Non-classifiable

These tweets are replies that cannot meaningfully be classified as either containing elements of hate or constructiveness. They are often very short tweets, or tweets that refer to something not political, or something external that cannot be seen (e.g. a simple url to some external website, or posting an image). This project is limited to building a classifier for text data, thus we had to remove all non-textual data.

i. **Referenced tweet:**
Opinion: How Republicans got so mean and clueless <Link>

Reply tweet*:*
Practice, practice.... <Link>

→ it is unclear what exactly is meant here without knowing what the link refers to.

ii. ***Reference tweet:***
But….Jussie made it political with the men in their MAGA Hats. He hates Trump.

Reply tweet:
@user Leave the presence of a fool, or you will not discern words of knowledge. Provers 14:7

→ The intended meaning of this bible quote is hard to place in this context.

iii. **Referenced tweet:**
What idiot called them "grammer nazis" and not "strunk and white supremacists"

Reply tweet*:*
LOL

→ it is unclear what exactly is meant here. The LOL (laughing out loud) could express that the replying user found the referenced tweet funny, but it could also be used in a derogatory way. Without further information we are unable to tell.